USER GUIDE

ACID DRUM 808

Complete user guide | v1.5.12

VST3 drum machine for Windows, developed and tested with FL Studio. 11 voices, 32 patterns, automation and 250 Factory presets.

1. Quick start

- 1. Load Acid Drum 808 as a VST3 instrument in the FL Studio Channel Rack.
- 2. Select BASS DRUM, SNARE DRUM or another voice at the top of the window.
- 3. Click the large steps 1–16 to program the hits.
- 4. Press PLAY or start the FL Studio transport.
- 5. Load a Factory preset or use SAVE PRESET to create your own.

Understand the layout

Item	Capacity
Voices	11 + ACCENT
Banks	A, B, C, D
Patterns	8 per bank, 32 total
Length	1–16 steps per pattern
Factory presets	250

2. Interface and parameters

Control	Action
PLAY / STOP	Start and stop sequencer playback
FL STUDIO SYNC	FL Studio host-sync indicator
FR / EN	Interface language
V1.5.12	Version shown in the window
UPDATE	Checks GitHub version information when reachable

Eleven drum voices

BASS DRUM, SNARE DRUM, LOW TOM, MID TOM, HI TOM, RIM SHOT, HAND CLAP, COWBELL, CYMBAL, OPEN HAT and CLSD HAT. ACCENT controls accent strength; it is not an additional drum voice.

Per-voice controls

- LEVEL sets each voice volume. Select a voice to see its other settings in the left panel.
- Depending on the voice, DECAY, TONE, PITCH, TUNING or SNAPPY may be available.
- PREVIEW plays the selected drum voice so you can check its settings.

Three-band compressor

Each voice has LOW, MID and HIGH compressor controls (0–100%). They adjust per-band compression intensity. ACCENT has no compressor.

3. Creating and editing patterns

- BANK A–D: choose the bank.
- PATTERN 1–8: choose one of eight patterns in the bank.
- NUMBER OF STEPS: choose 1–16 steps. The pattern loops at the selected length.
- Click large steps to turn hits on or off for the selected voice.
- Use the small ACCENT buttons above the grid to emphasize individual hits.

Control	What it does
COPY / PASTE	Copy/paste the current pattern
CLEAR	Clear the current pattern
RANDOM 16	Generate a random pattern
SHUFFLE	Add swing to off-beat steps

Basic House pattern example

Instrument	Steps on
Bass Drum	1, 5, 9, 13
Snare Drum	5, 13
Closed Hat	3, 7, 11, 15

Tip: start with A1, duplicate it to A2, then change the accents for a variation. Banks B, C and D can hold different song sections.

4. Factory / User presets

An .aciddrum808preset file stores all 32 patterns (and lengths), accents, sound settings and compressor controls.

Control	Action
LOAD PRESET	Windows picker starting in the last-used folder
SAVE PRESET	Windows “Save As” dialog to choose name and folder
Left/right arrows	Previous/next preset in the active directory
FOLDER	Opens the preset root

Folder organization

Typical user location: Documents\AcidDrum808\presets. Factory subfolders are grouped by style (Acid, Techno, Psytrance, etc.). The User folder is intended for personal creations.

New: preset restoration in FLP projects

• Load the preset you want, then save your FL Studio project (.flp).

• When reopening, Acid Drum 808 v1.5.12 restores the preset name and sequencer state: bank, pattern, voice, shuffle and settings.

• Each plugin instance keeps its own state inside the project, independently of Factory/User files.

Important: a project saved before v1.5.12 cannot recover a preset name that was not stored in that earlier project state.

5. Automation in FL Studio

Since v1.5.9, the main controls are exposed as automatable VST3 parameters. Version 1.5.11 fixed visual feedback: knobs follow parameter changes sent by FL Studio.

Create an automation clip

• 1. Open Acid Drum 808 in FL Studio and select a control, for example HI TOM → LEVEL.

• 2. Right-click the control and use the VST3/FL Studio parameter menu where available.

• 3. In FL Studio, select “Create automation clip”; if needed use Tools → Last tweaked → Create automation clip.

• 4. Draw the curve in the Playlist and press play. The knob should visibly follow the curve.

Supported controls

LEVEL for all 11 voices, ACCENT, DECAY, PITCH and other available voice-specific tone controls, plus all three compressor bands. Available controls depend on the selected voice.

Check automation playback

• Play the clip while the plugin window is open: the knob value and position should change.

• Save the FL Studio project to keep the clip. Automation curves are part of the project, not the preset file.

If a knob stays still, check the displayed version (v1.5.11 or later for visual synchronization) and confirm FL Studio is not loading an old VST3 copy.

6. MIDI and Piano Roll

Use MIDI / PIANO ROLL to display the note map. DAWs may label octaves differently: MIDI note numbers are the reliable reference.

Instruments

Voice	Note	MIDI
Bass Drum	C0	0
Snare Drum	D0	2
Low Tom	E0	4
Mid Tom	F0	5
Hi Tom	G0	7
Rim Shot	A0	9
Hand Clap	B0	11
Cowbell	C1	12
Cymbal	D1	14
Open Hat	E1	16
Closed Hat	F1	17

32 pattern triggers

Pattern	Bank A	Bank B	Bank C	Bank D
1	C3 / 36	D4 / 50	E5 / 64	F6 / 77
2	D3 / 38	E4 / 52	F5 / 65	G6 / 79
3	E3 / 40	F4 / 53	G5 / 67	A6 / 81
4	F3 / 41	G4 / 55	A5 / 69	B6 / 83
5	G3 / 43	A4 / 57	B5 / 71	C7 / 84
6	A3 / 45	B4 / 59	C6 / 72	D7 / 86
7	B3 / 47	C5 / 60	D6 / 74	E7 / 88
8	C4 / 48	D5 / 62	E6 / 76	F7 / 89

To trigger a pattern, place its note in the Piano Roll: it loops as long as the note is held.

7. MIDI import / export

Import a MIDI file

- Select the destination bank and pattern first.
- Click IMPORT MIDI and choose a .mid or .midi file.
- Standard MIDI type 0 or 1 files are supported for recognized drum notes.
- Import replaces the destination pattern. Check the active 1–16 steps.

Export a pattern

Select a pattern, click EXPORT MIDI and choose a filename and folder. Export covers the active pattern, not all 32. Accents are reflected in MIDI velocity.

GitHub update checks

Status	Meaning
UP TO DATE	No newer version found
UPDATE AVAILABLE	A newer GitHub release is available
UPDATE: OFFLINE	Network unavailable or manifest inaccessible
UPDATE: SETUP	Repository address not embedded in the plugin

UPDATE does not install anything by itself: it opens GitHub. Checking requires a publicly readable manifest; a private repository may show “OFFLINE”. Close FL Studio before installing an update.

8. Installation and troubleshooting

Installation and updates

• Close FL Studio before running Setup.exe.

• Use the proposed Windows VST3 directory, or select another directory scanned by your DAW.

• The installer includes 250 Factory presets. Existing preset files are not overwritten by the bank-copy process; still back up your User creations.

• Back up older VST3 copies outside every folder scanned by FL Studio.

Common issues

Issue	Suggested check
No sound	Check active steps, PLAY, LEVEL and FL Studio Mixer routing.
Preset not restored	Use v1.5.12; load preset, save FLP, close and reopen.
Knob does not move	Check automation, v1.5.11+ and which VST3 FL Studio loaded.
Old version displayed	Look for older VST3 files, including .backup bundles in scan folders.
Arrows do nothing	Load a preset in the desired folder; arrows browse that folder.
UPDATE offline	Check network connection and GitHub manifest public access.

License and credits

Acid Drum 808 contains code derived from DrumGroover by Reiner Prokein under the MIT license. Original and third-party notices must accompany public distribution.

Guide updated for v1.5.12. Some capabilities depend on the DAW, its MIDI settings and the selected VST3 directory.